



**BIRLA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY AND SCIENCE, Pilani**  
**Pilani Campus**  
**AUGS/ AGSR Division**

**I SEMESTER 2026-27**  
**COURSE HANDOUT**

**Date: 2.08.2026**

In addition to part I (General Handout for all courses appended to the Time table) this portion gives further specific details regarding the course.

**Course No** : ENGL C261 GSF241  
**Course Title** : Creative Writing  
**Instructor-in-Charge** : DEVIKA  
**Instructor(s)** : -  
**Tutorial/Practical Instructors:** -

**1. Course Description:**

Principles of creative writing, stimulating creative activity, techniques of creating images, constructing events and creating characters, writing short stories, digital storytelling and multimodal narratives, plays and poems, adaptation of creative writing across digital and social media, writing critical essays on works of art, AI and digital writing tools, authorship and ethics

**2. Scope and Objective of the Course:**

The objective of the course is to familiarize students with the nature and functioning of creative writing. Besides basic tenets of creative writing, the course will not only encourage the students to acquire techniques of constructing events, characters, writing poems, short stories and one act plays but also develop in them the ability to appreciate writings of all sorts. References to the related and contemporary works will be made from time to time during discussion and workshop.

**3. Text Books:**

Mills, Paul. 2006. *Creative Writing Course Book*. New York: Routledge.

**4. Reference Books:**

- (i) Jaron, Philip K. and Allan B. Lefcowitz. 2004. *Creative Writer's Hand Book*. 4<sup>th</sup> ed. Prentice Hall.
- (ii) Bulman, Colin. 2007. *Creative Writing: A guide and glossary to fiction writing*. Polity Press.
- (iii) Coles Notes. 1991. *Dictionary of Literary Terms*. Delhi: Chaman Enterprises.
- (iv) Minot, Stephen. 1971. *Three Genres: The Writing of Poetry, Fiction, and Drama*. Englewood Cliffs: Prentice-Hall.

**5. Course Plan:**

| Lec. | Lecture Topic                                     | Reference                  | Learning Outcomes                                                                  |
|------|---------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | <b>The Creative Mindset: What Makes a Writer?</b> | Text Ch. 1; Ref. (i) Ch. 1 | Understand the basic features that make writing creative and the creative process. |
| 2    | <b>Learning to Observe</b>                        | Text Ch. 1; Ref. (i) Ch. 2 | Develop observation skills and learn to use details as writing material.           |
| 3    | <b>Reading Like a Writer</b>                      | Text Ch. 1; Ref. (i) Ch. 1 | Read literary works for craft, technique, form and effect.                         |



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|----|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 4  | <b>Memory, Experience &amp; Imagination</b>       | Text Ch. 2; Ref. (i) Ch. 2        | Explore memory, experience and imagination as sources of creative writing.   |
| 5  | <b>Curiosity &amp; Finding Ideas</b>              | Text Ch. 1–2; Ref. (i) Ch. 2      | Generate and develop ideas through creative exercises and free writing.      |
| 6  | <b>Practice Session</b>                           | Application of preceding lectures | Apply the concepts through guided writing and receive feedback.              |
| 7  | <b>Developing an Authentic Writer's Voice</b>     | Text Ch. 1; Ref. (i) Ch. 1        | Develop an awareness of personal voice and style.                            |
| 8  | <b>Words that Matter: Diction &amp; Style</b>     | Text Ch. 1; Ref. (i) Ch. 4        | Use diction and style deliberately to shape meaning and effect.              |
| 9  | <b>Creating Images</b>                            | Text Ch. 1, 3; Ref. (i) Ch. 4–5   | Use imagery, figurative language and sensory detail to create vivid effects. |
| 10 | <b>Tone, Mood &amp; Emotional Expression</b>      | Text Ch. 1, 3; Ref. (i) Ch. 4–5   | Understand and control tone and emotional effect.                            |
| 11 | <b>Showing Rather than Telling</b>                | Text Ch. 1, 4; Ref. (i) Ch. 9     | Use concrete detail and scenes to make writing more immediate.               |
| 12 | <b>Practice Session</b>                           | Application of preceding lectures | Apply the concepts through guided writing and receive feedback.              |
| 13 | <b>Writing with Rhythm &amp; Flow</b>             | Text Ch. 3; Ref. (i) Ch. 5–7      | Develop rhythm, pacing and fluency in prose and poetry.                      |
| 14 | <b>Story, Plot &amp; Structure</b>                | Text Ch. 4; Ref. (i) Ch. 8–9      | Understand and organise the basic elements of story, plot and structure.     |
| 15 | <b>Creating Memorable Characters</b>              | Text Ch. 4; Ref. (i) Ch. 8        | Develop believable and distinctive characters.                               |
| 16 | <b>Conflict, Desire &amp; Motivation</b>          | Text Ch. 4; Ref. (i) Ch. 8–9      | Develop believable motivations and conflicts that drive narrative.           |
| 17 | <b>Point of View</b>                              | Text Ch. 4; Ref. (i) Ch. 3, 9     | Understand different perspectives and make appropriate narrative choices.    |
| 18 | <b>Practice Session</b>                           | Application of preceding lectures | Apply the concepts through guided writing and receive feedback.              |
| 19 | <b>Dialogue that Reveals Character</b>            | Text Ch. 4, 6; Ref. (i) Ch. 13    | Use dialogue to reveal character and advance action.                         |
| 20 | <b>Setting &amp; Atmosphere</b>                   | Text Ch. 4; Ref. (i) Ch. 8        | Create settings that contribute to character, action and atmosphere.         |
| 21 | <b>Theme, Symbolism &amp; Meaning</b>             | Text Ch. 4; Ref. (i) Ch. 8        | Understand how themes and symbols contribute to meaning.                     |
| 22 | <b>Beginning, Developing &amp; Ending Stories</b> | Text Ch. 4; Ref. (i) Ch. 8, 15    | Organise narrative progression towards an effective resolution.              |



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|----|------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 23 | <b>Why Genres Matter</b>                       | Text Ch. 1, 3, 4, 6; Ref. (i) Ch. 5, 8, 12         | Understand major genres, their conventions and appropriate forms.              |
| 24 | <b>Practice Session</b>                        | Application of preceding lectures                  | Apply the concepts through guided writing and receive feedback.                |
| 25 | <b>Writing Poetry</b>                          | Text Ch. 3; Ref. (i) Ch. 5–7; Ref. (iv) Part I     | Apply the basic principles of poetic language and form.                        |
| 26 | <b>Writing Fiction</b>                         | Text Ch. 4; Ref. (i) Ch. 8–9; Ref. (iv) Part II    | Apply the basic elements of fiction in developing a short story.               |
| 27 | <b>Writing Drama</b>                           | Text Ch. 6; Ref. (i) Ch. 12–14; Ref. (iv) Part III | Apply the basic elements of drama in writing a one-act play.                   |
| 28 | <b>Creative Non-fiction</b>                    | Text Ch. 2; Ref. (i) Ch. 10                        | Transform experience into effective creative non-fiction.                      |
| 29 | <b>Travel, Feature &amp; Editorial Writing</b> | Text Ch. 2; Ref. (i) Ch. 10                        | Recognise and apply creative approaches to practical non-fiction writing.      |
| 30 | <b>Practice Session</b>                        | Application of preceding lectures                  | Apply the concepts through guided writing and receive feedback.                |
| 31 | <b>Playing with Form</b>                       | Text Ch. 1; Ref. (i) Ch. 1                         | Experiment with form without restricting imaginative possibilities.            |
| 32 | <b>Retelling &amp; Adaptation</b>              | Text Ch. 1, 4, 6; Ref. (i) Ch. 8, 14               | Transform existing narratives through changes in form, perspective or context. |
| 33 | <b>Writing from Visual Arts</b>                | Text Ch. 1; Ref. (i) Ch. 4                         | Translate visual experience into descriptive and interpretive writing.         |
| 34 | <b>Developing Personal Style</b>               | Text Ch. 1; Ref. (i) Ch. 1, 4                      | Refine individual style through comparison, practice and experimentation.      |
| 35 | <b>Revision: Re-seeing Writing</b>             | Text Ch. 1, 4; Ref. (i) Ch. 15                     | Re-see and rework drafts to improve structure, meaning and effect.             |
| 36 | <b>Practice Session</b>                        | Application of preceding lectures                  | Apply the concepts through guided writing and receive feedback.                |
| 26 | <b>Writing Fiction</b>                         | Text Ch. 4; Ref. (i) Ch. 8–9; Ref. (iv) Part II    | Apply the basic elements of fiction in developing a short story.               |
| 27 | <b>Writing Drama</b>                           | Text Ch. 6; Ref. (i) Ch. 12–14; Ref. (iv) Part III | Apply the basic elements of drama in writing a one-act play.                   |



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| 37 | <b>Editing for Precision &amp; Impact</b>      | Text Ch. 1, 4; Ref. (i) Ch. 15          | Edit writing for clarity, precision and impact.                                |
| 38 | <b>Workshop Practice &amp; Peer Critique</b>   | Text Ch. 1; Ref. (i) Ch. 15             | Use discussion and feedback to analyse and improve creative work.              |
| 39 | <b>Ethics &amp; Creative Responsibility</b>    | Text Ch. 1; Ref. (i) Ch. 15             | Recognise ethical responsibilities in creative writing.                        |
| 40 | <b>Building a Writing Portfolio</b>            | Text Ch. 1; Ref. (i) Ch. 15             | Select, revise and organise representative creative work.                      |
| 41 | <b>The Writer Beyond the Classroom</b>         | Text Ch. 1, 2, 3, 4, 6; Ref. (i) Ch. 15 | Reflect on continued creative practice and the practical life of a writer.     |
| 42 | <b>Practice Session</b>                        | Application of preceding lectures       | Apply the concepts through guided writing and receive feedback.                |



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**6. Evaluation Scheme:**

| Component                 | Duration | Weightage (%) | Date & Time | Nature of component (Close Book/ Open Book) |
|---------------------------|----------|---------------|-------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Mid-Semester Test         | 90 Min.  | 20            | <TEST_1>    | OB                                          |
| Comprehensive Examination | 3 Hrs.   | 30            | <TEST_C>    | OB                                          |
| Assign                    |          | 50            |             | CB/OB                                       |

**7. Participatory evaluation:** Open source reference class discussion will take place and formative feedback will be shared.

**8. Chamber Consultation Hour:** Tuesday, 11:00 am or any other day with prior permission.

**9. Notices:** Notices will be displayed on Nalanda only.



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**10. Make-up Policy:** Prior written permission is to be taken for the genuine reasons.

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**11. Note (if any): Self Reading:** References would be made to the selected works given below.

**Poems:**

Shall I Compare Thee to a Summer's Day – William Shakespeare  
On his Blindness – John Milton – Selected stanzas from Paradise Lost  
Daffodils – William Wordsworth  
Because I Could Not Stop for Death – Emily Dickinson  
The Thought-Fox – Ted Hughes  
The Love Song of J Alfred Prufrock – TS Eliot – selected stanzas from The Waste Land  
John Donne – The Sun Rising  
Ode to a Nightingale – John Keats  
Rabbi Ben Ezra – Robert Browning  
In Memoriam - Alfred Tennyson  
Kubla Khan – ST Coleridge – Selected sections from The Rime of the Ancient Mariner

**Short Stories:**

The Gift of the Magi – O' Henry  
The Lumber-Room – Saki  
The Lady with the Little Dog – Anton Chekhov  
God Sees the Truth, But Waits – Leo Tolstoy  
The Tell-Tale Heart – Edgar Allan Poe  
Rip Van Winkle – Washington Irving  
The Necklace – Guy de Maupassant

**Drama:**

Oedipus Rex – Sophocles  
King Lear – William Shakespeare  
Candida – George Bernard Shaw

**Fiction:**

Gone with the Wind – Margaret Michael  
Anna Karenina – Leo Tolstoy  
The Great Gatsby – F Scott Fitzgerald

**Non Fiction:**

The Prince – Niccolo Machiavelli  
The Republic – Plato

**Painters:**

Michelangelo  
Leonardo da Vinci  
Claude Monet  
Pablo Picasso  
Vincent van Gogh  
Rembrandt

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